

KQL 201: An Intermediary Course on KQL

<https://kc7cyber.com/challenges/1667>

Time Analysis - Filter events by date ranges, spot patterns by hour, and track how long attacks lasted using `startofday()`, `between`, and `bin()`.

Aggregation - Go beyond simple counts with `dcount()` to find unique values, `min()` and `max()` to track timelines, and `make_set()` to group related indicators.

Data Transformation - Clean up output with `project`, add calculated columns with `extend`, and flag suspicious activity with `iff()` and `case()`.

Advanced Filtering - Search smarter with `startswith`, `endswith`, `has_any`, and exclude noise with `!in`.

Along the way, we'll investigate a password spray attack and use these techniques to uncover the attacker's patterns.

You've completed KQL 201! Here's what you learned:

Time Analysis

`datetime()`, `startofday()`, `endofday()`, `between`, `ago()`, `bin()`

Aggregation

`summarize`, `count()`, `dcount()`, `min()`, `max()`, `make_set()`, `top`, `sort`

Data Transformation

`project`, `extend`, `iff()`, `case()`

Advanced Filtering

`startswith`, `endswith`, `in`, `!in`, `has_any`